Pick Your Video Style

Choose the right motion style for your video

Goal lookup | score sheet | worked examples
Companion to The Code-Video Playbook

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1. How to use this selector

Pick the style from your video, not from the look you like most. This guide gives you three ways, from fastest to most careful:

Method	Time	Use when
A. Goal lookup (section 2)	30 seconds	You already know what the video must achieve
B. Score sheet (sections 3-4)	3 minutes	You are unsure or two styles seem to fit
C. Ask Claude (section 8)	1 minute	Paste the template and get a ranked answer

Style codes used in the score sheet:

Code	Style	One-line essence
K	Kinetic Type	Loud, fast, bold words on near-black; creator energy
C	Chalk Talk	Teacher drawing on a slate, one continuous lesson
T	Clean Tech	Calm product explainer with UI cards and diagrams
W	Software Walkthrough	Cursor and clicks; shows exactly how to do it
D	Data Story	Charts and numbers with the source on screen
M	Warm Canvas	You on camera, then cards on a warm canvas
P	Pop Info	Flat cartoon scene with a character and a thought bubble

> **Rule of thumb**
> One **primary** style per video. You may borrow at most one small element from a second style (for example a Kinetic Type hook before a Warm Canvas edit). Mixing three styles looks messy.

2. Quick lookup by goal

If the video must...	Best	Runner-up	Why
Sell, hook or get follows (Shorts, Reels, ads)	K	T	Fast words and hard cuts hold attention
Explain how a system or AI workflow works	T	K	Diagrams, nodes and cards make logic visible
Teach a concept step by step	C	T	Drawing while speaking matches how people learn
Show how to do a task in an app	W	T	Cursor and zoom show the exact clicks
Prove a point with numbers	D	T	Charts draw to scale and keep the source visible
Build trust in you as a person	M	K	Your face and voice carry the video
Make a dry topic friendly and memorable	P	C	A character and a story lower the barrier
Announce a product feature	T	W	Clean cards and a clear result
Recap a talk, lesson or interview	M	C	Your footage plus cards for the key ideas

These pairings are recommendations based on how each style is built, not measured performance data.

3. The score sheet

Answer each question below. For each answer you pick, add the points listed to each style's running total. Skip points that are not listed (they are zero). Use the blank tally in section 4.

Q1. What is the main thing on screen?

Your answer	Add points
Me talking to camera	M +3, K +1
A screen recording of software	W +3, K +1, T +1
Numbers, charts, a spreadsheet	D +3, T +1
Just ideas and words (no footage)	K +2, T +2, C +1, P +1
A story or situation with a character	P +3, C +1

Q2. What should viewers do or feel at the end?

Your answer	Add points
Get hyped and take action (buy, join, follow)	K +3, T +1
Understand how something works	T +2, C +2, D +1
Be able to do the task themselves, click by click	W +3
Trust a conclusion because of the evidence	D +3, M +1
Relate and smile	P +3, C +1
Trust me personally	M +3, C +1

Q3. What tone fits?

Your answer	Add points
Loud, fast, bold	K +3
Calm, polished, professional	T +2, W +2, D +2, M +1
Warm, personal, editorial	M +3, D +1
Teacher-like, handmade	C +3
Playful, friendly	P +3

Q4. How long and where will it play?

Your answer	Add points
Under 60 seconds, vertical (Shorts, Reels, TikTok)	K +2, P +1, T +1
1 to 3 minutes	T +1, D +1, K +1, P +1, M +1
3 to 10 minutes (YouTube, course, tutorial)	W +2, C +2, M +2, D +1

Q5. Who is watching?

Your answer	Add points
Creators, freelancers, small business owners	K +2, T +1
Software users or customers	W +2, T +2
Students and learners	C +2, P +1, T +1
Executives, analysts, press	D +2, T +1
General public, kids, families	P +2, C +1
My own followers who already know me	M +2, K +1

Q6. Hard rules (apply these after scoring)

- **No footage of yourself?** Remove Warm Canvas (M) from consideration.
- **No app or screen to show?** Walkthrough (W) can still work with a fake UI built in code, but a real recording is better. If neither, drop W.
- **No data or numbers?** Drop Data Story (D). Do not invent figures to fit the style.
- **Need it under 15 seconds?** Drop Chalk Talk (C); it is built for slower, continuous lessons.

4. Tally and read the result

Style	K	C	T	W	D	M	P
Total	____	____	____	____	____	____	____

Result	What to do
One style leads by 4 or more	Use it as the primary style. Done.
Top two within 3 points	Pick the one that matches Q1 (what is on screen). Borrow one element from the other.
Three or more tied	Your video has no clear focus. Rewrite the one-sentence goal, then score again.
Top score is a style you ruled out in Q6	Use the next highest style.

5. Worked examples

Example A: "How to land your first client with AI automations" (30-second Reel)

Question	Answer chosen	Points
Q1	Just ideas and words	K +2, T +2, C +1, P +1
Q2	Get hyped and take action	K +3, T +1
Q3	Loud, fast, bold	K +3
Q4	Under 60 seconds	K +2, P +1, T +1
Q5	Creators and freelancers	K +2, T +1
Total	K 12, T 5, P 2, C 1	**Winner: Kinetic Type**

Add a Clean Tech-style diagram beat if you need to show the automation flow.

Example B: "How to set up our new dashboard" (5-minute tutorial)

Question	Answer chosen	Points
Q1	Screen recording	W +3, K +1, T +1
Q2	Do the task click by click	W +3
Q3	Calm and professional	T +2, W +2, D +2, M +1
Q4	3 to 10 minutes	W +2, C +2, M +2, D +1
Q5	Software users	W +2, T +2
Total	W 12, T 5, D 3, M 3, C 2, K 1	**Winner: Software Walkthrough**

Example C: "3 lessons I learned freelancing" (you talking to camera, 6 minutes)

Question	Answer chosen	Points
Q1	Me talking to camera	M +3, K +1
Q2	Trust me personally	M +3, C +1
Q3	Warm and personal	M +3, D +1
Q4	3 to 10 minutes	W +2, C +2, M +2, D +1
Q5	My own followers	M +2, K +1
Total	M 13, C 3, K 2, D 2, W 2	**Winner: Warm Canvas**

Other topics, scored by judgement

Topic	Pick	Reason
Why rent rose 12 percent in five years (with a dataset)	D	Numbers are the proof; show the source
Explain compound interest to a teenager	C or P	C for classroom feel, P for a friendly story
Launch video for a new app feature	T	Clean cards, one result, calm voice
Why people hate slow checkout lines (humorous)	P	Character reacts; a scene carries the idea
3 mistakes beginners make with AI tools	K	Wrong-idea strikes, stamps and punchy words

6. When a style is the wrong choice

Style	Avoid it when
Kinetic Type (K)	The topic is sensitive, grief-related or medical; it feels pushy. Also avoid for long, quiet lessons.
Chalk Talk (C)	You need speed or a polished corporate look; it is slow and handmade by design.
Clean Tech (T)	You want emotion or personality; it is deliberately neutral.
Software Walkthrough (W)	There is no product or flow to demonstrate.
Data Story (D)	You do not have real data and a source. Never make up figures.
Warm Canvas (M)	You have no footage of yourself or are camera-shy.
Pop Info (P)	The audience expects serious authority (legal, financial, medical advice).

7. Match style to what you have

Style	Needs footage?	Voice that fits	Build effort (rough)	Best length
K Kinetic Type	Optional	Fast, energetic; or none	Medium-high	15-90 sec
C Chalk Talk	No	Calm teacher voice	High (drawn motion)	2-8 min
T Clean Tech	No	Friendly, medium pace	Low-medium	30 sec - 3 min
W Walkthrough	Real recording best	Clear tutorial voice	Medium (low with a recording)	1-10 min
D Data Story	No (needs data file)	Measured, editorial	Medium	1-4 min
M Warm Canvas	Yes, your talking head	Your own voice	Medium (depends on footage)	2-10 min
P Pop Info	No	Warm narrator or character	High (illustrated scenes)	30 sec - 3 min

Effort and length columns are my rough guidance from how each style is built, not benchmarks. If you are new, start with Clean Tech or Kinetic Type: they need no footage and are the quickest to get right.

Voice mode check

- **Your real voice or face:** Warm Canvas, Kinetic Type, or Walkthrough.
- **AI narration (Kokoro, Edge TTS):** Clean Tech, Data Story, Chalk Talk, Pop Info.
- **No voice at all (music and effects only):** Kinetic Type, Clean Tech, Data Story, Pop Info all work with on-screen text carrying the message.

8. Let Claude pick for you

Copy this, fill the brackets, and send it in a Claude chat. It returns a ranked pick and the prompt to build it.

```
Help me choose a video style. My video:
- Topic / script: [paste]
- Goal: [sell | teach | prove with data | show a tutorial | build trust | entertain]
- Length and platform: [e.g. 45s vertical Reel | 5 min YouTube]
- What I have: [talking-head footage | screen recording | data file | nothing]
- Voice: [my voice | AI voice | none]
- Audience: [who watches]
Styles to choose from: Kinetic Type, Chalk Talk, Clean Tech, Software
Walkthrough, Data Story, Warm Canvas, Pop Info.
Score them, give me a ranked top 3 with one-line reasons, say what to avoid,
then write the build prompt for the winner (storyboard first, wait for my OK).
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9. Safe hybrids

Combination	How to do it
K + M	Open with 5 seconds of Kinetic Type for the hook, then the Warm Canvas edit.
T + D	Clean Tech layout with one Data Story chart as the proof beat.
W + T	Walkthrough for the clicks, Clean Tech diagram to explain what happens behind the scenes.
C + P	Keep chalk drawing, add one small character reaction beat for humour.
K + W	Kinetic Type title and result, with a tilted screen recording in the middle.
Rule	Keep fonts, palette and sound consistent; more than one 10-second borrowed beat means the primary style is wrong.